

### 3.1.4 Area of study 3: Music for media

For the purpose of this specification, music for media is defined as music specifically composed for film, television and gaming from 1958 to the present.

#### Named composers

- Bernard Herrmann
- Hans Zimmer
- Michael Giacchino
- Thomas Newman
- Nobuo Uematsu

#### Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section C (Essay) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section C (Essay) of the exam.

| Element type | Element                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Melody       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• leitmotif.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| Harmony      | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• power chords</li><li>• sus4 chords</li><li>• chord extensions – 7<sup>th</sup>, 9<sup>th</sup>, 11<sup>th</sup>, 13<sup>th</sup></li><li>• other complex chords eg half diminished 7<sup>th</sup>, added 6<sup>th</sup></li><li>• chord symbols eg C/E C<sup>7</sup> C<sup>ø</sup> and C<sup>+</sup></li><li>• tonic and dominant pedal.</li></ul> |
| Tonality     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• tonal</li><li>• atonal</li><li>• modal.</li></ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

| Element type            | Element                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Structure               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• cue</li> <li>• underscore</li> <li>• soundtrack</li> <li>• mickey-mousing</li> <li>• diegetic and non-diegetic music</li> <li>• source music.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                               |
| Sonority (Timbre)       | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• standard orchestral instruments</li> <li>• standard jazz, rock and pop instruments</li> <li>• electronic instruments</li> <li>• ethnic instruments suitable for sense of location</li> <li>• technological effects eg echo, reverb, panning, distortion</li> <li>• tremolo.</li> </ul> |
| Texture                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• cluster</li> <li>• polarised texture</li> <li>• drone.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Tempo, metre and rhythm | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• mm (metronome marking)</li> <li>• additive rhythm</li> <li>• cross rhythm</li> <li>• rhythmic layering.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                     |